ERROR ANALYSIS OF LLMS ON ROMANIAN POLYSEMANTIC CROSSWORD CLUES: WHAT THE HINTS ACTUALLY BUY

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ABSTRACT

We re-examine the solving results of four LLMs (Granite-4.0-small, Llama-3.3-70B, gpt-oss-120B and Claude Opus 4.8) on POLYCROSS (polysemantic clues) and THEMCROSS (straight thematic clues) under seven hinting regimes, together with the Romanian base model LLMic-v2-3B under the five regimes a base model can be prompted for. We (i) rescore every model on the same 3000 POLYCROSS items that Claude was evaluated on, (ii) replace case-insensitive exact match with a diacritic-insensitive match, and (iii) decompose accuracy by how much of the answer the hint gives away. Three findings change how the headline numbers should be read. First, strict matching penalised the open models by up to 10 points, and the apparent loss from chain-of-thought (v4 vs. v3) was almost entirely a diacritic artifact. Second, at the four-letter prefix hint 44% of items have their answer fully spelled out by the hint; restricted to items where letters remain hidden, POLYCROSS accuracy drops by 10–18 points for the stronger models, and on answers with three or more hidden letters it stays near 50%. Third, weaker models lose a large share of items simply by ignoring the hint, whereas the stronger models' residual errors are hint-compliant words with the wrong meaning — the failure mode the benchmark is designed to expose. The Romanian base model is weakest on both counts: it rarely respects the length hint, and where letters remain hidden it solves about 5% of POLYCROSS items.

1 SETUP AND RESCORING

Items. POLYCROSS is scored on the 3000-item sample `polycross_sample3000.json` (seed 42, answers of at least three letters) that Claude Opus 4.8 was evaluated on; THEMCROSS on its 1148 items with answers of at least three letters. The three open models were originally run on the full ∼26k-item POLYCROSS corpus; we align their predictions to the sample by (clue, answer). An item missing from a run (a request that failed every retry) counts as wrong, so every cell has the same denominator. The one run that did not exist, Llama-3.3-70B on POLYCROSS at k=4, was produced on the 3000 sample with the same prompt (59.8%; the 52.3% quoted in the rebuttal has no corresponding result file, and the new run uses the current RITS deployment of the model). Table 8 shows that the sample tracks the full corpus to within about one point, so conclusions from the sample transfer.

Conditions. v1: clue only; v2: clue + answer length; v3: length + the first $k \in \{1, 2, 3, 4\}$ letters; v4: v3 with chain-of-thought (answer in brackets); v5: length hint, reason in English and answer in Romanian. When the answer has at most k letters the prefix hint contains the whole answer.

A Romanian base model. LLMic-v2-3B (Bădoiu et al., 2025; arXiv:2501.07721) is a 3B-parameter Romanian–English *foundation* model without instruction tuning or a chat template, so it cannot follow the JSON instruction prompts above. We evaluate it with few-shot *completion* prompts that carry the same three worked examples and the same hint wording as v1–v3, ending in "Răspuns:"; the answer is its greedy continuation up to the first newline. v4 and v5 rely on following instructions and have no base-model analogue, so they are omitted ("–" in the tables). The prompts must be tokenized with the model's own `tokenizer.json`: the default `transformers` 5 tok-

enizer class drops its newline pre-tokenizer, and with it the model produces no usable answers (0.0% on POLYCROSS v1).

Diacritic-insensitive scoring. Gold answers are written without diacritics (ZAMBILA), while models frequently answer with them (ZAMBILĂ), and the original metric counted those as errors. We now compare both strings after Unicode NFD decomposition, removal of combining marks, upper-casing and removal of non-letters (which also neutralises the lower-case intersection markers in POLYCROSS answers such as PRAF). We report this as *accuracy* throughout; Table 6 in the appendix gives the strict numbers.

Table 1: Accuracy (%, diacritic-insensitive) on the common item sets. Best per column in bold. Len = length hint; Tr. = translate (v5). 95% bootstrap intervals are at most ±1.8 points on POLYCROSS and ±3.0 on THEMCROSS.

			v3: length + prefix				v4: v3 + CoT				v5
Model	No	Len	k=1	k=2	k=3	k=4	k=1	k=2	k=3	k=4	Tr.
PolyCross											
Granite-4.0-small	0.6	1.1	5.1	11.8	28.7	40.8	3.5	7.0	20.3	32.7	0.7
Llama-3.3-70B	2.5	4.1	12.3	25.0	43.3	59.8	14.1	25.4	46.9	58.8	4.6
gpt-oss-120B	3.8	7.9	23.0	39.7	61.4	76.6	23.5	40.0	62.9	76.3	8.0
Claude Opus 4.8	**5.2**	**8.7**	**28.4**	**50.7**	**75.8**	**85.6**	**29.6**	**50.7**	**75.9**	**86.1**	**8.8**
LLMic-v2-3B	0.4	0.1	1.5	3.9	22.8	43.6	–	–	–	–	–
ThemCross											
Granite-4.0-small	11.1	13.6	20.1	27.2	40.4	54.4	11.4	15.4	19.3	30.1	9.8
Llama-3.3-70B	30.9	35.2	46.1	52.7	63.9	74.3	48.1	53.3	63.8	73.8	39.4
gpt-oss-120B	35.2	46.6	56.9	64.4	77.6	87.5	58.9	65.6	76.5	88.2	47.6
Claude Opus 4.8	**59.1**	**65.1**	**83.0**	**88.3**	**92.8**	**95.5**	**83.0**	**88.3**	**93.5**	**95.6**	**73.5**
LLMic-v2-3B	4.7	3.7	7.4	11.9	26.7	47.3	–	–	–	–	–

Effect of rescoring. Table 7 lists the change per cell. It is small for Claude Opus 4.8, whose answers are nearly always diacritic-free (the exception is v5 on THEMCROSS, +5.7), and substantial for the open models, above all under the bracketed-answer prompts: gpt-oss-120B gains 9.8 points on POLYCROSS v4 k=4 (66.5→76.3) and 9.1 on THEMCROSS v4 k=1. Two conclusions of the original analysis change as a result (§5): chain-of-thought no longer hurts the stronger models, and the translation prompt is no worse than the plain length hint.

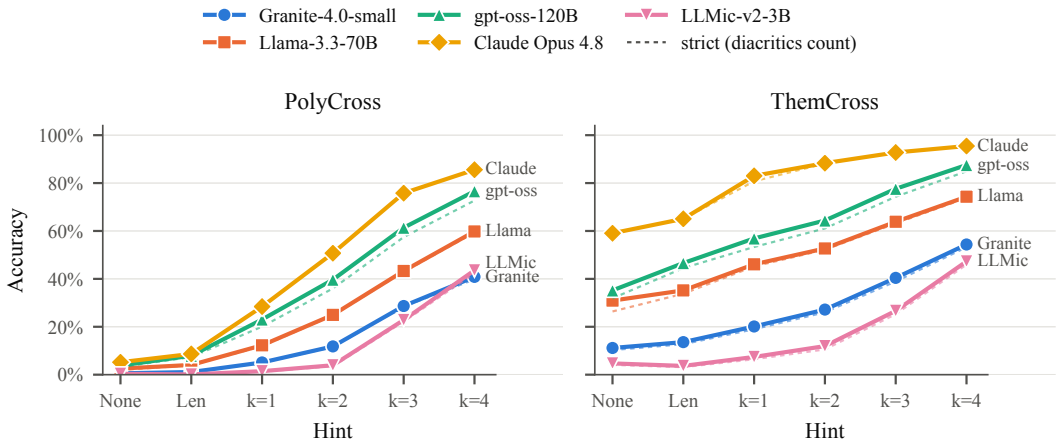


Figure 1: Accuracy along the hint ladder (v1, v2, v3 k=1..4). Solid: diacritic-insensitive; dashed: strict. The gap between the two lines is the diacritic penalty; it is widest for gpt-oss-120B.

2 How much of the answer does the hint give away?

Accuracy rises steeply with k (Figure 1), and on PolyCross the four-letter hint takes Claude Opus 4.8 from 8.7% to 85.6%. How much of this reflects clue understanding? We split items by the number of letters the hint leaves hidden, $|a| - k$ (Table 2, Figure 2).

Fully revealed answers. At k=4, 44.0% of PolyCross and 44.7% of ThemCross items have $|a| \leq 4$, so the hint *is* the answer. Claude Opus 4.8 and gpt-oss-120B score 97–100% on these, as expected. Granite-4.0-small and Llama-3.3-70B do not: they return the given string on only 57–69% and 64–86% of these items respectively, typically by producing a longer word that starts with the hint. This is a hint-following failure, not a reasoning one. LLMic-v2-3B copies the hint on 87% (k=3) and 94% (k=4) of these PolyCross items, more often than Granite or Llama, and they account for almost all of its accuracy: its 43.6% at k=4, which puts it above Granite-4.0-small, falls to 4.2% on the remaining items, the lowest of all models.

Informative-hint accuracy. Restricted to items with $|a| > k$, PolyCross accuracy at k=4 is 75.1% for Claude Opus 4.8 (vs. 85.6% overall) and 58.5% for gpt-oss-120B (vs. 76.6%). With three or more letters hidden it falls to 52.9% and 46.1%. On ThemCross the same restriction costs Claude less than 3 points: straight definitions remain solvable when the hint leaves most of the word open, polysemantic ones do not. We recommend reporting informative-hint accuracy alongside overall accuracy for all prefix conditions.

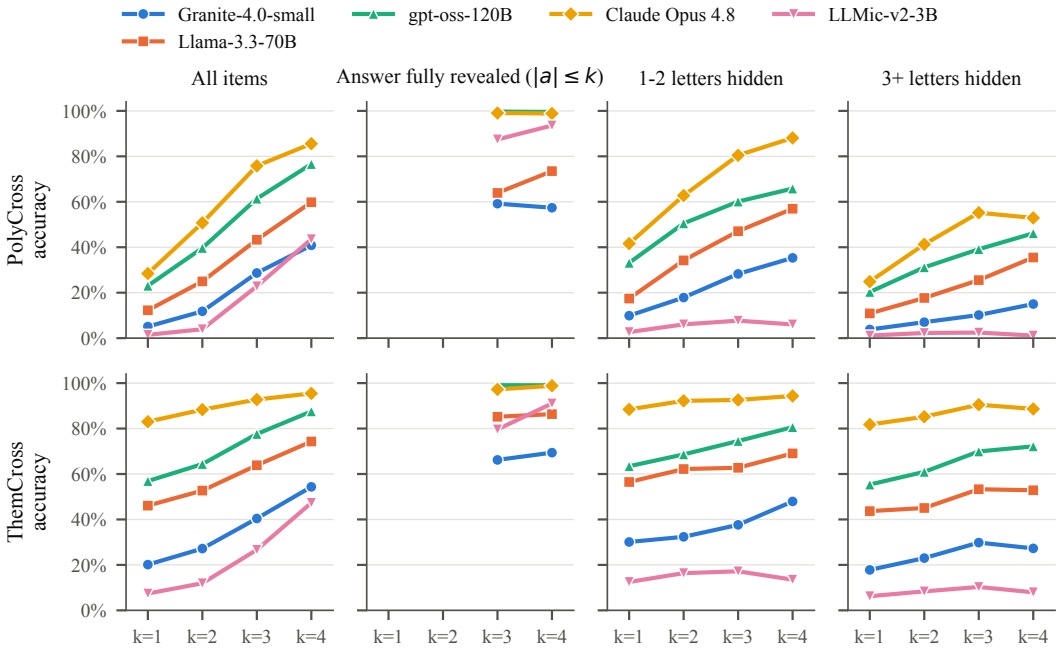


Figure 2: v3 accuracy by how many answer letters the hint leaves hidden. The "fully revealed" panel only exists for $k \geq 3$ because all answers have at least three letters.

How constraining is the hint? A complementary view counts how many words from the crossword vocabulary (the union of all answers in both full corpora, 11.9k types) fit the length and prefix. Figure 3 pools v3 over k, excluding fully revealed items. On PolyCross, accuracy falls monotonically with the number of candidates for every model: Claude Opus 4.8 goes from 78% when a single vocabulary word fits to 22% when more than 100 do. On ThemCross its curve is nearly flat (95%→81%). The contrast is the clearest signature of the benchmark's premise: for polysemantic clues, a large part of the prefix-hint gain comes from narrowing the candidate set rather than from resolving the clue.

Table 2: v3 accuracy (%) by the number of letters the hint leaves hidden. Gray: share of items in the stratum at each k.

Items	Model	PolyCross k=1	PolyCross k=2	PolyCross k=3	PolyCross k=4	ThemCross k=1	ThemCross k=2	ThemCross k=3	ThemCross k=4
$\lvert a\rvert \le k$ *(answer fully revealed)*		0%	0%	21%	44%	0%	0%	19%	45%
	Granite-4.0-small	–	–	59.2	57.4	–	–	66.2	69.4
	Llama-3.3-70B	–	–	63.9	73.5	–	–	85.2	86.4
	gpt-oss-120B	–	–	99.7	99.5	–	–	99.1	99.0
	Claude Opus 4.8	–	–	99.1	98.9	–	–	97.2	98.8
	LLMic-v2-3B	–	–	87.4	93.6	–	–	79.6	91.0
$\lvert a\rvert - k \in \{1, 2\}$		21%	44%	45%	35%	19%	45%	48%	40%
	Granite-4.0-small	9.9	17.9	28.3	35.3	30.1	32.4	37.6	47.9
	Llama-3.3-70B	17.4	34.2	47.1	56.9	56.5	62.2	62.7	69.1
	gpt-oss-120B	33.1	50.5	60.1	65.8	63.4	68.6	74.5	80.6
	Claude Opus 4.8	41.6	62.8	80.5	88.1	88.4	92.2	92.6	94.3
	LLMic-v2-3B	2.7	6.1	7.7	6.0	12.5	16.4	17.2	13.5
$\lvert a\rvert - k \ge 3$		79%	56%	34%	21%	81%	55%	33%	15%
	Granite-4.0-small	3.8	7.0	10.2	15.0	17.8	23.0	29.8	27.3
	Llama-3.3-70B	10.9	17.7	25.5	35.5	43.7	45.0	53.3	52.8
	gpt-oss-120B	20.3	31.1	39.1	46.1	55.4	60.9	69.9	72.2
	Claude Opus 4.8	24.9	41.3	55.2	52.9	81.8	85.2	90.5	88.6
	LLMic-v2-3B	1.1	2.3	2.4	1.1	6.2	8.3	10.3	8.0
$\lvert a\rvert > k$ *(informative)*		100%	100%	79%	56%	100%	100%	81%	55%
	Granite-4.0-small	5.1	11.8	20.4	27.8	20.1	27.2	34.4	42.2
	Llama-3.3-70B	12.3	25.0	37.7	49.0	46.1	52.7	58.9	64.6
	gpt-oss-120B	23.0	39.7	51.0	58.5	56.9	64.4	72.6	78.3
	Claude Opus 4.8	28.4	50.7	69.5	75.1	83.0	88.3	91.7	92.8
	LLMic-v2-3B	1.5	3.9	5.4	4.2	7.4	11.9	14.4	12.0

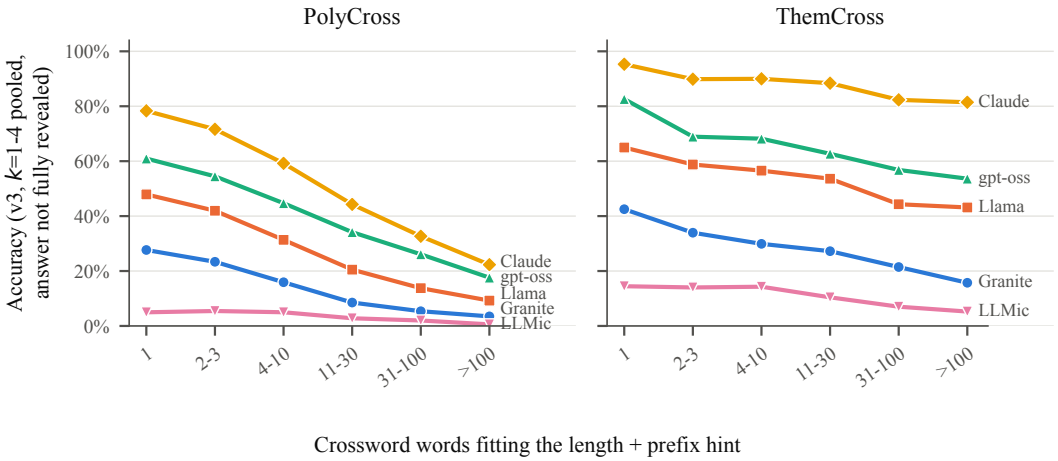


Figure 3: v3 accuracy against the number of crossword-vocabulary words consistent with the hint.

Answer length. Figure 4 breaks accuracy down by answer length. On PolyCross without prefix hints, accuracy is in single digits at every length. Once letters are given, short answers are solved first and long answers lag: at k=4 Claude Opus 4.8 solves 91% of five-letter but only 34% of 10+-letter PolyCross answers. On ThemCross length matters much less.

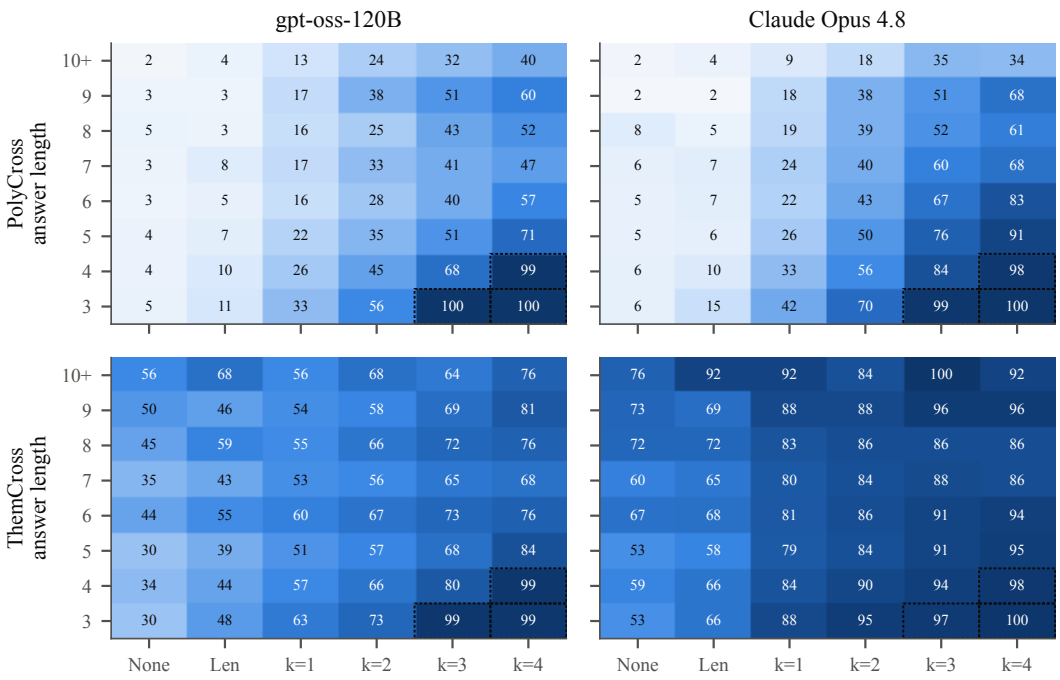


Figure 4: Accuracy (%) by answer length and hint level for the two strongest models. Dotted cells: the hint contains the whole answer.

3 What kinds of errors remain?

We assign each wrong prediction to the first matching category: *no answer* (empty or unparseable); *wrong length* (the length was given but not respected); *wrong prefix* (given letters not respected); *one letter off* (edit distance 1 from the answer, counted only when at least two letters were hidden, since otherwise every wrong completion is trivially one edit away); and *other word, fits hint*. Figure 5 shows the composition.

Hint violations dominate for the weaker models. Granite-4.0-small gives an answer of the wrong length on 31–53% of PolyCross items at every hint level, and Llama-3.3-70B on 19–33%. Among answered items, gpt-oss-120B and Claude Opus 4.8 respect both the length and the prefix 92–99% of the time (Table 9 in the appendix). LLMic-v2-3B keeps the given prefix on 91–100% of items but the given length on only 17–45% on PolyCross (19–51% on ThemCross): the few-shot completion conveys the letters, but the base model does not treat the stated length as a constraint. Wrong length is therefore its dominant error at every hint level.An exception is Claude Opus 4.8 at v2 on PolyCross, which violates the length on 13.1% of items, more than gpt-oss-120B (3.4%): without letters to anchor it, it sometimes prefers a semantically apt word of the wrong length.

The stronger models fail on meaning, not on form. For gpt-oss-120B and Claude Opus 4.8, almost all remaining errors are hint-compliant words, which is the failure mode the benchmark targets: the model settles on a reading of the clue that yields a plausible word of the right shape, but not the intended one. Near misses (one letter off) are a small share throughout, so partial credit would change little. Table 10 lists examples. They also show that many PolyCross answers are not dictionary words but crossword fragments or multi-word strings (ATOT, TRIA, VINCUSIFON, INELDEAUR, "3 cuv."), which a model cannot reach without the crossword convention that licenses them.

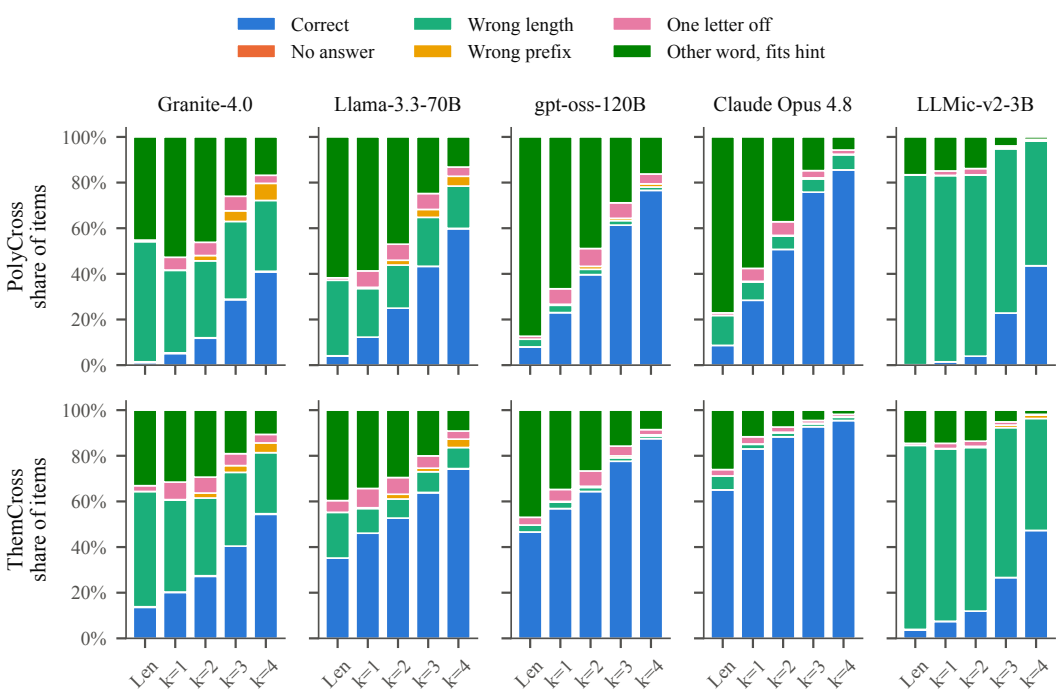


Figure 5: Share of all items that are correct or fall into each error category, per model and hint level.

4 Difficulty across models and hint levels

Agreement. Figure 6 counts how many of the models solve each item, over the conditions every model was run on (v1–v3; five models including LLMic-v2-3B). Without prefix hints, 91.3% (v1) and 85.1% (v2) of PolyCross items are solved by no model at all, versus 36.0% and 28.6% on ThemCross. Items solved by exactly one model are overwhelmingly Claude's: at v3 k=2 it solves 445 PolyCross items that no other model does, against 205 for gpt-oss-120B. Claude Opus 4.8 beats gpt-oss-120B significantly (exact McNemar, $p < 0.01$) in every PolyCross condition with a prefix hint and in every ThemCross condition, but not at v2 or v5 on PolyCross ($p = 0.22$, 0.16), where both are below 9%.

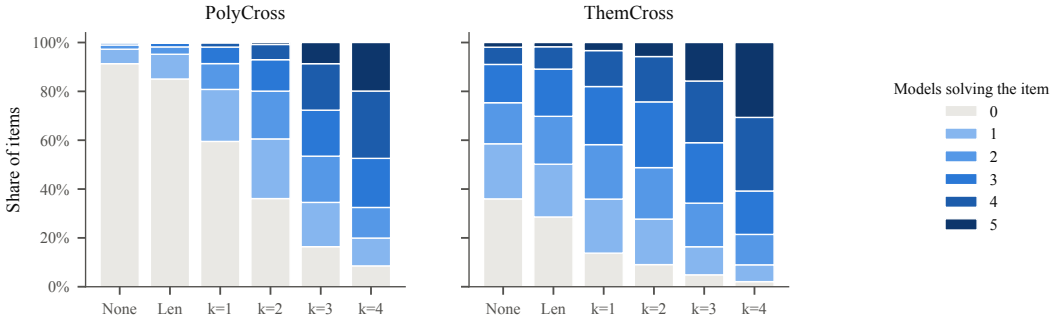


Figure 6: Share of items solved by none, some or all of the models, per hint level (v1–v3).

When is an item first solved? Along the ladder v2 → v3 k=1..4 (Table 3), most ThemCross items that Claude Opus 4.8 solves are solved with the length hint alone (67% of the items it ever solves), whereas on PolyCross they are spread across k=1–3. The ladder is not monotone: 8.6% of PolyCross items are solved by Claude at some k and missed again at a larger k, and 5–12% for the other models (6–21% across models on ThemCross). Part of the gain from one hint level to

the next is therefore sampling variance rather than information, which argues for reporting intervals (Table 1 caption) and paired tests rather than point differences.

Table 3: The hint level at which each item is first solved (% of items), items never solved, and items solved at some level but missed at a larger one.

		First solved at						
Dataset	Model	Len	k=1	k=2	k=3	k=4	Never	Lost later
PolyCross	Granite-4.0-small	1.1	4.5	8.4	19.1	16.3	50.5	12.3
	Llama-3.3-70B	4.1	8.7	14.9	21.4	17.1	33.9	10.9
	gpt-oss-120B	7.9	16.0	18.6	22.7	15.3	19.6	8.9
	Claude Opus 4.8	8.7	20.7	24.3	24.7	11.0	10.6	8.6
	LLMic-v2-3B	0.1	1.4	3.8	20.7	20.2	53.8	5.5
ThemCross	Granite-4.0-small	13.6	9.9	11.1	14.6	14.6	36.1	20.5
	Llama-3.3-70B	35.2	15.3	10.9	11.8	11.4	15.4	21.3
	gpt-oss-120B	46.6	14.7	8.5	11.9	9.2	9.0	12.5
	Claude Opus 4.8	65.1	19.1	6.8	3.7	2.9	2.4	6.2
	LLMic-v2-3B	3.7	5.3	7.7	17.1	18.8	47.5	12.2

5 PROMPTING STRATEGIES REVISITED

Chain-of-thought (v4 vs. v3). Under strict scoring, v4 appeared to hurt gpt-oss-120B by up to 6 points at k=4 on POLYCROSS. After rescoring the two are within 2 points at every k for gpt-oss-120B and Claude Opus 4.8, and no difference is significant at $p < 0.01$ (Table 4). The strict penalty came from the bracketed free-text answer, where models write diacritics more often than in the JSON answer of v3. Chain-of-thought does help Llama-3.3-70B on POLYCROSS at k=3 (+3.6, $p < 0.01$), and clearly hurts Granite-4.0-small (up to -24 points on THEMCROSS), which often fails to produce the bracketed answer in the right form.

Table 4: Accuracy difference v4 − v3 (points). *: exact McNemar $p < 0.01$.

Dataset	Model	k=1	k=2	k=3	k=4
PolyCross	Granite-4.0-small	-1.6*	-4.8*	-8.3*	-8.1*
	Llama-3.3-70B	+1.9*	+0.4	+3.6*	-1.0
	gpt-oss-120B	+0.4	+0.4	+1.5	-0.3
	Claude Opus 4.8	+1.2	-0.0	+0.1	+0.5
	LLMic-v2-3B	–	–	–	–
ThemCross	Granite-4.0-small	-8.7*	-11.8*	-21.1*	-24.2*
	Llama-3.3-70B	+2.0	+0.6	-0.1	-0.5
	gpt-oss-120B	+2.0	+1.2	-1.1	+0.6
	Claude Opus 4.8	+0.0	+0.0	+0.7	+0.2
	LLMic-v2-3B	–	–	–	–

Translation (v5 vs. v2). Both prompts give only the length hint; v5 additionally asks the model to reason in English. After rescoring, v5 matches v2 for gpt-oss-120B and Claude Opus 4.8 on POLYCROSS and *exceeds* it for Claude on THEMCROSS (73.5 vs. 65.1; Table 5). The rate of answers outside the crossword vocabulary rises by at most 2 points under v5 for the stronger models (and falls for Claude on THEMCROSS), so we find no evidence that answers are lost in translating back to Romanian. The one clear failure is Granite-4.0-small, which gives no usable answer on 21% (POLYCROSS) and 28% (THEMCROSS) of v5 items. The difficulty of polysemantic clues therefore lies in finding the intended sense, which translation neither creates nor removes.

Table 5: Translate (v5) vs. length hint (v2), %. No ans.: empty or unparseable. OOV (out of vocabulary): answered with a word that is not an answer anywhere in either full corpus (an overestimate because of inflected forms; compare columns rather than read absolute values). Len. ok: answer has the given length.

		Acc.		No ans.		OOV		Len. ok	
Dataset	Model	v2	v5	v2	v5	v2	v5	v2	v5
PolyCross	Granite-4.0-small	1.1	0.7	0.4	20.6	72.3	71.5	47.1	38.6
	Llama-3.3-70B	4.1	4.6	0.0	1.8	63.1	50.8	66.9	75.1
	gpt-oss-120B	7.9	8.0	0.1	4.4	44.0	45.7	96.6	96.5
	Claude Opus 4.8	8.7	8.8	0.0	0.0	53.7	53.2	86.9	82.2
ThemCross	Granite-4.0-small	13.6	9.8	0.3	27.8	68.2	69.8	49.3	41.0
	Llama-3.3-70B	35.2	39.4	0.0	1.7	46.2	38.4	80.0	84.3
	gpt-oss-120B	46.6	47.6	0.0	0.9	30.1	31.6	97.0	97.0
	Claude Opus 4.8	65.1	73.5	0.0	0.0	23.3	14.7	93.9	96.6

6 TAKEAWAYS

1. **Score without diacritics.** Strict matching understated the open models by up to 10 points and produced two spurious conclusions (chain-of-thought and translation both appearing to hurt).
2. **Report informative-hint accuracy.** At $k \geq 3$ a large fraction of items is solved by the hint alone. Accuracy on $|a| > k$, and on $|a| - k \geq 3$, measures clue understanding far better.
3. **The POLYCROSS–THEMCROSS gap survives every control.** With three or more letters hidden, Claude Opus 4.8 reaches 89% on THEMCROSS but 53% on POLYCROSS at $k=4$; without prefix hints the gap is 54–65 points for Claude and 31–40 for gpt-oss-120B.
4. **Weaker models fail on form, stronger ones on meaning.** Hint violations explain much of the gap between Granite/Llama and the rest; the remaining errors of the strongest models are well-formed words with the wrong sense. The Romanian base model LLMic-v2-3B has the lowest informative-hint accuracy of all models in every condition, mainly because it ignores the length hint.

A ADDITIONAL TABLES

Table 6: Strict accuracy (%, case-insensitive exact match, diacritics count), as in the original analysis but on the common item sets.

			v3: length + prefix				v4: v3 + CoT				v5
Model	No	Len	k=1	k=2	k=3	k=4	k=1	k=2	k=3	k=4	Tr.
PolyCross											
Granite-4.0-small	0.5	1.1	4.9	11.6	28.4	39.8	2.6	6.0	18.5	29.6	0.6
Llama-3.3-70B	1.9	3.9	11.9	24.7	42.9	59.3	11.7	21.5	42.1	53.5	3.9
gpt-oss-120B	3.2	7.4	20.1	36.0	57.4	72.7	18.5	32.5	53.7	66.5	6.5
Claude Opus 4.8	**5.2**	**8.7**	**28.4**	**50.7**	**75.8**	**85.6**	**29.6**	**50.7**	**75.9**	**86.1**	**8.8**
LLMic-v2-3B	0.3	0.1	1.2	3.5	22.1	42.3	–	–	–	–	–
ThemCross											
Granite-4.0-small	10.3	12.7	19.0	26.0	38.9	53.2	9.7	12.9	16.7	27.7	8.0
Llama-3.3-70B	26.4	33.8	45.2	52.2	63.2	73.8	42.5	47.7	58.8	67.9	35.5
gpt-oss-120B	31.9	44.5	53.3	61.1	74.3	84.9	49.8	56.9	69.3	85.0	39.3
Claude Opus 4.8	**59.0**	**65.1**	**80.7**	**88.2**	**92.8**	**95.5**	**82.8**	**88.2**	**93.5**	**95.6**	**67.8**
LLMic-v2-3B	4.1	3.1	6.4	10.5	25.3	46.0	–	–	–	–	–

Table 7: Change from rescoring: diacritic-insensitive minus strict accuracy (points).

			v3: length + prefix				v4: v3 + CoT				v5
Model	No	Len	k=1	k=2	k=3	k=4	k=1	k=2	k=3	k=4	Tr.
PolyCross											
Granite-4.0-small	0.1	0.0	0.2	0.2	0.2	1.0	0.8	1.0	1.8	3.1	0.1
Llama-3.3-70B	0.6	0.1	0.4	0.2	0.4	0.5	2.4	3.9	4.8	5.3	0.7
gpt-oss-120B	0.6	0.5	3.0	3.7	3.9	3.9	5.0	7.6	9.2	9.8	1.5
Claude Opus 4.8	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.1
LLMic-v2-3B	0.1	0.0	0.2	0.4	0.7	1.2	–	–	–	–	–
ThemCross											
Granite-4.0-small	0.9	0.9	1.1	1.1	1.5	1.1	1.7	2.5	2.6	2.4	1.7
Llama-3.3-70B	4.5	1.4	0.9	0.5	0.7	0.5	5.6	5.6	5.0	5.8	3.9
gpt-oss-120B	3.3	2.1	3.6	3.3	3.3	2.6	9.1	8.7	7.2	3.1	8.4
Claude Opus 4.8	0.1	0.0	2.3	0.2	0.0	0.0	0.2	0.1	0.0	0.0	5.7
LLMic-v2-3B	0.6	0.5	1.0	1.4	1.4	1.3	–	–	–	–	–

Table 8: The open models on POLYCROSS: full corpus (their original runs) vs. the 3000-item sample. The Llama k=4 run exists only on the sample.

		Full corpus (∼26k)		Sample (3000)	
Model	Cond.	strict	no-diac.	strict	no-diac.
Granite-4.0-small	No hint	0.6	0.7	0.5	0.6
Granite-4.0-small	Length	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1
Granite-4.0-small	v3 k=2	11.7	12.0	11.6	11.8
Granite-4.0-small	v3 k=4	39.7	40.5	39.8	40.8
Granite-4.0-small	v4 k=4	29.2	32.4	29.6	32.7
Granite-4.0-small	Translate	0.6	0.7	0.6	0.7
Llama-3.3-70B	No hint	1.7	2.2	1.9	2.5
Llama-3.3-70B	Length	3.5	3.6	3.9	4.1
Llama-3.3-70B	v3 k=2	24.3	24.7	24.7	25.0
Llama-3.3-70B	v4 k=4	55.2	60.4	53.5	58.8
Llama-3.3-70B	Translate	3.8	4.5	3.9	4.6
gpt-oss-120B	No hint	2.8	3.4	3.2	3.8
gpt-oss-120B	Length	7.6	8.2	7.4	7.9
gpt-oss-120B	v3 k=2	34.8	38.4	36.0	39.7
gpt-oss-120B	v3 k=4	72.8	76.6	72.7	76.6
gpt-oss-120B	v4 k=4	67.1	76.4	66.5	76.3
gpt-oss-120B	Translate	6.4	8.0	6.5	8.0

Table 9: Hint compliance among answered items (%): answer has the given length (v2–v5), and the given length and prefix (v3/v4).

Dataset	Model	Length	v3 k=1	v3 k=2	v3 k=3	v3 k=4	Translate
PolyCross	Granite-4.0-small	47.1	63.6	63.9	61.2	61.4	38.6
	Llama-3.3-70B	66.9	78.2	79.0	75.1	77.1	75.1
	gpt-oss-120B	96.6	96.4	96.4	97.0	97.2	96.5
	Claude Opus 4.8	86.9	91.7	93.9	93.7	93.1	82.2
	LLMic-v2-3B	16.8	18.3	20.5	27.5	44.9	–
ThemCross	Granite-4.0-small	49.3	59.4	63.7	64.7	68.9	41.0
	Llama-3.3-70B	80.0	88.9	89.5	89.4	87.1	84.3
	gpt-oss-120B	97.0	96.9	97.7	97.6	98.3	97.0
	Claude Opus 4.8	93.9	97.8	98.0	98.5	98.3	96.6
	LLMic-v2-3B	19.1	24.2	27.8	33.2	49.5	–

Table 10: Wrong answers at v3 k=2 on POLYCROSS, sampled at random per error category.

Clue	Answer	Prediction	Model
One letter off			
Ultima rezervă de materie cenuşie	URNA	URMA	Claude Opus 4.8
Rezultatul adunării	ATOT	ATOM	Claude Opus 4.8
Animal... pentru tăiat de ocazie	LAMA	LADA	Claude Opus 4.8
Implicată într-o afacere în pierdere	DATA	DANA	gpt-oss-120B
Impun măsuri restrictive pentru limitarea debordărilor	LIMITATIVI	LIMITATIVE	gpt-oss-120B
O fată care stă la tuşă	VARA	VACA	gpt-oss-120B
Other word, fits hint			
A avansa de la echipa mare	TRIA	TREC	Claude Opus 4.8
Active pe perioada alegerilor	SITE	SIGL	Claude Opus 4.8
Oglindiți în lumina adevărului	REALI	REDAT	Claude Opus 4.8
Pornire cu violenţă	ARTAG	ARUNC	gpt-oss-120B
Ataşat naval	VAS	VAL	gpt-oss-120B
Nimb prețios pentru sanctitatea iubirii (3 cuv.)	INELDEAUR	IN INIMA TA	gpt-oss-120B
Wrong length			
Iarba verde unde se iese cu grupul	PASCATOARE	PAJISTELE	Claude Opus 4.8
Dă semne că se face rău	AVERTIZARE	AVERTIZEA	Claude Opus 4.8
Disimularea unui om cu pretenții exagerate	INFUMURARE	INFATUARE	Claude Opus 4.8
Tensiunea instalată pentru senzori de vibraţii	NELINISTE	NECESITA	gpt-oss-120B
Instalat din start printre favoriți	ATU	ATOP	gpt-oss-120B
Atac la persoană	MISTOCARIE	MISOGENIE	gpt-oss-120B
Wrong prefix			
Substratul unui adevăr... pus la îndoială	VINCUSIFON	VERIDICITA	Claude Opus 4.8
Precedent pentru noi	NEO	NOU	Claude Opus 4.8
Odoare iubite de părinți (sing.)	ORAR	ODOR	Claude Opus 4.8
Pune bazele înălţării	CTITOR	CIMENT	gpt-oss-120B
Rezultatul adunării	NOIAN	NUMAR	gpt-oss-120B
Concept generic de acțiune în scădere	IEFTINIRE	DIMINUARE	gpt-oss-120B